But then I also had the manuscript of The Stars, like Dust— from Brad, and it was torn apart. Fred's news was an upward ripple in a downward avalanche, and the two collaboration sales couldn't even begin to compensate for the double failure of my new novel. As I said in my diary, "I feel like a fired science-fiction writer."

At least I had gone over my robot stories, made the necessary corrections in the printed versions, and left them for Gertrude to type up.

And on April 1, 1950, I started The Stars, like Dust— for the third time, from scratch.

2 5

On April 6, I received the news from Sprague de Camp that Campbell and his wife had separated and that Dona had moved in with George O. Smith. 7 Apparently, Campbell's overwhelming involvement with dianetics had been the last straw for Dona.

That same day Kupchan drove to New York, and on April 7 I went in to see Brad with Chapter 1 of the third version of The Stars, like Dust—. He said he liked it, but I suppressed my enthusiasm. It was only the first chapter.

On the ninth, I went to Philadelphia to attend an American Chemical Society meeting, and there I met with the de Camps. The next day I visited the Navy Yard for the first time in four years, but already there had been enough changes in personnel to make the place strange to me. I never went back again.

On the thirteenth, Sprague and I went over the new May 1950, As-tounding, which, with great fanfare, ran L. Ron Hubbard's 16,000-word article "Dianetics."

Apparently, Hubbard was maintaining that all human beings had their thinking mechanisms distorted by impressions received in the fetal stage. The fetus could hear, be aware, and misunderstand all that

7 There was always the tendency, somehow, for marital musical chairs in the science-fiction fraternity. Dick Wilson, for instance, had married Fred Pohl's first wife.

took place, and these misunderstandings produced all the wronghead-edness that plagued the human species. If each individual could be taken back,